during his tenure as the state police chief under MGR's rule. Multiple sources, agencies and the media were accusing the SIT of a 'partisan probe', but nobody came up with any proof. Too many conjectures were doing the rounds. At least at that point of time.

A section of the investigators increasingly claimed to have definite knowledge of Sivarasan's visits to Sweden, Singapore and France to procure arms and explosives and his jaunts to Saudi Arabia and the UAE to raise funds. What they were baffled about was why a functionary not very highly placed in the organization had been sent on missions that were always handled by top-level functionaries such as Kittu Anandan, Anton Balasingham and military head Mahathaya. While Kaarthikeyan had his reasons to ignore such intelligence on the fugitive, at least two senior members of his team—Kanth and Verma—came up with a new hypothesis that Sivarasan might have been acting on his own in liaising with groups other than the LTTE.

Multiple intelligence agencies, including those from other countries, backed his communication with sources other than Jaffna. It was a complex issue. The pressure to catch the mastermind was mounting. Persuading leads pertaining to his foreign links were left for future action—at least till after Sivarasan had been caught. Also, even as ramifications of the case widened, one could see the relationship between the SIT, the state police and the IB turning cold. While the SIT accused the state police of non-cooperation in private, the state police resented the SIT's high profile, which was consciously trying to hog all credit.[18]